



AN ESTONIAN official displays photos of Russian fighter jets as he addresses the U.N. Security Council.

Amid the convulsions of wars, global leaders convene at U.N.

Gathering comes as the world body is itself undergoing crisis

By Edith M. Lederer

UNITED NATIONS — World leaders began convening Monday at one of the most volatile moments in the United Nations’ 80-year history, and the challenges they face are as dire as ever if not more so: unyielding wars in Gaza and Ukraine, escalating changes in the U.S. approach to the world, hungry people everywhere and technologies that are advancing faster than the understanding of how to manage them.

The United Nations, which emerged from World

War II’s rubble on the premise that nations would work together to tackle political, social and financial issues, is in crisis itself. As Secretary-General António Guterres said last week: “International cooperation is straining under pressures unseen in our lifetimes.”

Yet the annual high-level gathering at the U.N. General Assembly will bring presidents, prime ministers and monarchs from about 150 of the 193 member nations to the organization’s headquarters. The secretary-general says it is an opportunity that can’t be

missed — even in the most challenging of moments.

“We are gathering in turbulent — even uncharted — waters,” Guterres said. He pointed to, among other specters, “our planet overheating, new technologies racing ahead without guardrails, inequalities widening by the hour.”

At the opening commemoration of this year’s 80th anniversary of the United Nations, General Assembly President Annalena Baerbock said the world is at a crossroads as it was after World War II, and courage is needed “to show the world

that we can be better together.”

“Today,” she said, “is not about celebrating.”

France on Monday became the latest country to recognize Palestinian statehood at the start of the high-profile meeting aimed at galvanizing support for a two-state solution to the Mideast conflict. The United Kingdom, Canada, Australia and Portugal recognized the state of Palestine on Sunday. More nations are expected to follow, in defiance of Israel and the United States.

Guterres said he will use [See United Nations, A4]

Big Tech rattled by Trump’s H-1B fees

Companies will have to cough up \$100,000 for every skilled foreign worker visa.

By Queenie Wong and Nilesh Christopher

President Trump’s new sky-high visa fees have shaken Silicon Valley’s tech giants as they contemplate a surge in the cost of hiring global talent and a new tactic the White House can use to keep Silicon Valley in line.

The tech industry was already navigating an economy with higher and unpredictable tariffs, when last week the Trump administration threw another curveball aimed directly at its bottom line: a \$100,000 fee for the visas used to hire certain skilled foreign workers. The industry relies heavily on the H-1B visa program to bring in a wide range of engineers, coders and other top talent to the United States.

The rollout has sparked confusion among businesses, immigration lawyers and current H-1B visa holders.

Over the weekend, the Trump administration clarified that the new fee will apply to new visas, isn’t annual and doesn’t prevent current H-1B visa holders from traveling in and outside of the country. Companies would have to pay the fee with any new H-1B visa petitions submitted after a specific time on Sunday, the White House said.

On Monday, the Trump administration also clarified that certain professions, such as doctors, may be exempt from the fee. Some observers are concerned that a selective application of the [See Visas, A10]



EDDIE Patino holds a protest sign on Monday outside the El Capitan Theatre.

Jimmy Kimmel’s show coming back to ABC after suspension

Disney’s move had sparked loud protests calling for protection of free speech.

By Meg James and Stephen Battaglio

Walt Disney Co. will bring Jimmy Kimmel back to ABC on Tuesday night, reversing its suspension of the late-night talk show after the host’s comments about the shooting death of conservative activist Charlie Kirk set off a political firestorm.

“Last Wednesday, we made the decision to suspend production on the show to avoid further inflaming a tense situation at an emotional moment for our country,” the company said Monday in a statement. “It is a decision we made because we felt some of the comments were ill-timed and thus insensitive.”

“We have spent the last days having thoughtful conversations with Jimmy, and after those conversations, we reached the decision to return the show on Tuesday.”

Kimmel’s representa-

tives declined to comment.

The breakthrough came as Disney faced withering pressure on multiple fronts.

Protests grew loud and some consumers, including radio personality Howard Stern, announced they had canceled their Disney+ subscriptions to lodge their dismay. More than 400 celebrities, including such Disney talent as Selena Gomez, Martin Short, Jamie Lee Curtis, Kerry Washington and Lin-Manuel Miranda, signed an open letter decrying attempts at government censorship, which “strike at [See Kimmel, A14]

Trump steps up attacks on foes, 1st Amendment

Legal experts call his use of presidential powers in last few days unprecedented.

By Ana Ceballos, Michael Wilner and Kevin Rector

WASHINGTON — President Trump has harnessed the weight of his office in recent days to accelerate a campaign of retribution against his perceived political enemies and attacks on 1st Amendment protections.

In the last week alone, Trump replaced a U.S. attorney investigating two of his political adversaries with a loyalist and openly directed the attorney general to find charges to file against them.

His Federal Communications Commission chairman hinted at punitive actions against networks whose journalists and comedians run afoul of the president.

Trump filed a \$15-billion lawsuit against the New York Times, only to have it thrown out by a judge.

The acting U.S. attorney in Los Angeles asked the Secret Service to investigate a social media post by Gov. Gavin Newsom’s press office.

The Pentagon announced it was imposing new restrictions on reporters who cover the U.S. military.

The White House officially labeled “antifa,” a loose affiliation of far-left extremists, as “domestic terrorists” — a designation with no basis in U.S. law — posing a direct challenge to free speech protections. And it said lawmakers concerned with the legal predicate for strikes on boats in the Caribbean should simply get over it.

An active investigation into the president’s border advisor over an alleged bribery scheme involving a \$50,000 payout was quashed by the White House itself.

Trump emphasized his partisan-fueled dislike of his political opponents during a Sunday memorial service for conservative activist Charlie Kirk, who he said “did not hate his opponents.”

“That’s where I disagreed with Charlie,” Trump said. “I hate my opponents and I

don’t want the best for them.”

It has been an extraordinary run of attacks using levers of power that have been seen as sacred arbiters of the public trust for decades, scholars and historians say.

The assault is exclusively targeting Democrats, liberal groups and establishment institutions, just as the administration moves to shield its allies.

Erik Siebert, the U.S. attorney in Virginia, resigned Friday after facing pressure [See Trump, A7]

Antifa declared terrorist group

Trump’s push to target left-wing movement raises questions on free speech and law.

By Jenny Jarvie

President Trump moved Monday to classify the left-wing, anti-fascist movement known loosely as antifa as a domestic terrorist organization, opening up a new front in his battle with political foes and raising legal and ethical questions about how the U.S. government can prosecute a movement.

Antifa activism and violence has spread during the Trump years. Since he took office in 2017, its targets have broadened as militant anti-fascist protesters — concealing their identities with masks, dressing head to toe in black — have sparred with police to block a right-wing provocateur speaking at UC Berkeley, confronted alt-right demonstrators with sticks, shields and chemical irritants in Charlottesville, Va., stormed a federal courthouse while protesting [See Antifa, A6]

Judge orders U.S. to restore UCLA grants

By Jaweed Kaleem

A federal judge Monday ordered the Trump administration to restore \$500 million in UCLA medical research grants, halting for now a nearly two-month funding crisis that UC leaders said threatened the future of the nation’s premier public university system.

The opinion by U.S. District Judge Rita F. Lin of the Northern District of California added UCLA’s major National Institutes of Health grants to an ongoing class-action lawsuit that had already led to the reversal of tens of millions of dollars in grants from the National Science Foundation, Environmental Protection Agency, National Endowment for the Humanities and other federal agencies to UC campuses.

Lin’s order provides the biggest relief to UCLA but affects federal funding awarded to all 10 University of California campuses. Lin ruled that the NIH grants were suspended by form letters that were unspecific to the research, a likely violation of the Administrative Procedure Act, which regulates executive branch rule-making.

In addition to the medical grant freezes — which

had led to talk of possible UCLA layoffs or closures of labs conducting cancer and stroke research, among other diseases — Lin said the government would have to restore a smaller amount of Department of Defense and Department of Transportation grants to UC schools.

Lin elaborated on her thinking in a hearing Thursday, saying that the Trump administration had undertaken a “fundamental sin” in its “un-reasoned mass terminations” of the grants using “letters that don’t go through the required factors that the agency is supposed to consider.”

The preliminary injunction would be in place as the case proceeds through the courts. But in broadening the case, Lin agreed with plaintiffs that there would be irreparable harm if the suspensions were not immediately reversed.

The judge, a Biden appointee, told Department of Justice lawyers to make a court filing by Sept. 29 explaining “all steps” the government has taken to comply with her order or, if necessary, explain why the restoring of grants “was not feasible.”

Spokespeople for the Department of Health and Hu- [See UCLA, A6]

Trump links Tylenol, autism

Health experts are dismayed as the president echoes a talking point of Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. **NATION, A5**

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Seismic report won’t be released

County won’t share study on government building’s safety amid concerns over costs of a retrofit. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Weather
Variable cloudiness.
L.A. Basin: 88/69 **B6**

Dodgers’ bullpen turns desperate

Team is considering Roki Sasaki for playoff role, Dylan Hernández writes. **SPORTS, B10**

